Lesson 6 — A Plan for Tuesday

Part 5 of 12: The short 'll and the weak going to

Level: B1 (sixth step)

About 20 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

3.7 The short 'll, and the weak going to (listen to `05-11-and-gonna.mp3`)

The whole future tense can disappear into one sound. If you cannot hear it, you will think somebody is talking about now.

1. will becomes 'll, and 'll is one consonant.

WRITTEN IN FULL	WHAT YOU HEAR	NOT THIS
I will take it.	/aɪl ˈteɪk ɪt/	/aɪ wɪl ˈteɪk ɪt/
It will be ready.	/ɪtl̩ bi ˈredi/	/ɪt wɪl bi ˈredi/
We will still have them.	/wil stɪl ˈhæv ðəm/	/wiː wɪl .../
She will finish it.	/ʃil ˈfɪnɪʃ ɪt/	/ʃiː wɪl .../

The full /wɪl/ comes back in three places only: at the end of a sentence (Yes, it will), in the negative (won't** /wəʊnt/), and when the speaker is insisting.

2. going to becomes **/ˈgənə/**.

Before another verb, going to loses almost everything. This is normal speech, not slang, and every speaker does it:

WRITTEN	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY HEAR
I am going to start at six.	/aɪm ˈgənə ˈstɑːt ət sɪks/
She is going to submit it.	/ʃiz ˈgənə səbˈmɪt ɪt/
We are going to get better.	/wə ˈgənə get ˈbetə/
They are not going to wait.	/ðeə nɒt ˈgənə ˈweɪt/

Write going to. Say **/ˈgənə/**. The written form never changes; only the sound does.

3. One warning. going to keeps its full sound when going is a real verb of movement: I am going to the college /ˈgəʊɪŋ tuː/ — she is going somewhere, not planning something.

In the audio you hear each line twice, and then a test: say whether what you hear is will or going to.